# JACOBY TRANSFERS

## ABOUT THE DEALS

You may be either Opener or Responder, but you will always be in the South position.

Feel free to disagree with some of the bids that do not apply directly to Transfers. Deals 9 and 21 for example.

Although it is not included in the Deals you might wish to examine your and dummy's hand and make a Plan of how you would play the contract.

## JACOBY TRANSFERS SUMMARY

Created by Oswald Jacoby a lot of years ago, there are two good reasons to use Transfers.

1. They provide a precise bidding method when the Responder to a 1NT opening has a 5 or 6 card Major suit.
2. They make the opening 1NT hand the declarer, keeping the stronger hand concealed.

Jacoby Transfers should only be used in conjunction with the Stayman Convention. The two work smoothly together with Stayman taking care of those hands where Responder has a 4-card Major(s) and Jacoby Transfers taking care of those hands where Responder has a 5- or 6-card Major.

The actual working of transfer bids is simple:
After a 1NT opening a 2♦ response requires Opener to bid 2♥, while a 2♥ response requires Opener to bid 2♠.
On his next bid Responder clarifies the picture by either placing the contract or by inviting Opener to do so.

Jacoby Transfers take much of the guesswork (sometimes called judgement) out of the bidding and steer you directly to these two goals:

1. With a partnership 26 points you will reach game, with 33 you will reach slam.
2. With a partnership 8+ cards in a Major suit you will play in that suit, otherwise you will play notrump.

For the first point consider this table which is based on the 1NT opener holding 15-17 points.

| Resp Points | Opener Points | | | Bidding Target |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | 15 | 16 | 17 | |
| 8 | 23 | 24 | 25 | Partscore |
| 9 | 24 | 25 | 26 | |
| 10 | 25 | 26 | 27 | |
| 11 | 26 | 27 | 28 | |
| 12 | 27 | 28 | 29 | Game |
| 13 | 28 | 29 | 30 | |
| 14 | 29 | 30 | 31 | |
| 15 | 30 | 31 | 32 | |
| 16 | 31 | 32 | 33 | |
| 17 | 32 | 33 | 34 | Slam |
| 18 | 33 | 34 | 35 | |

Responder's actions are as follows:

- 8 points or fewer - either pass or transfer and then pass
- 9 points - invite partner to game
- 10 points - either invite or force to game, using your judgement
- 11-15 points - force to game
- 16 points - invite to slam
- 17 points - either invite or force to slam, using your judgement
- 18 points or more - force to slam

Opener's actions are as follows:

- 15 points - decline invitations
- 16 points - either decline or accept, using your judgement
- 17 points - accept invitations

As to the second point above (the 8-card trump fit) you must keep in mind that it is correct to open 1NT with 5-3-3-2 distribution, so it is possible for Opener to have a doubleton in the Major suit that Responder is interested in. Therefore Responder must bid differently with a 5-card suit than he does with a 6-card suit.

- With a 5-card Major Responder transfers Opener to that Major suit, then at his next turn bids notrump.
- With a 6-card Major Responder transfers Opener to that Major suit, then at his next turn rebids the suit.

Opener also has to keep on the right track when Responder has shown only 5 of the suit by rebidding notrump.

- With 2 cards in the transferred suit Opener stays with notrump.
- With 3+ cards in the transferred suit Opener returns to the Major suit.

Some comments are in order about the point count methods used on these pages.

- Initial point count for both hands is based on 4-3-2-1 plus one point for a fifth card in a suit.
- Revalued points (only after a trump fit is discovered) are +1 for a doubleton held by Opener.

- Responder must be very cautious about adding short-suit revalued points. As the long-trump hand Responder will not be able to gain a trick by ruffing since it usually uses a trump which would be a winner anyway.

25 examples will be worth more than another 1000 words.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣6

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣2

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦2

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣10

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠K

***Board 1***
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 7 5
♥ J 8
♦ A Q 6
♣ Q J 7 4

♠ 10 8 6 4 3
♥ A K 4 3
♦ J 8
♣ A 10




♠ A J
♥ 7 5
♦ 10 9 7 3 2
♣ 9 6 5 2

♠ 9 2
♥ Q 10 9 6 2
♦ K 5 4
♣ K 8 3

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1NT | Pass | 2♦ |
| Pass | 2♥ | Pass | 2NT |
| All Pass | | | |

2NT by North
Lead: ♣6

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♦.

This is an easy one. Partner has commanded you to say 2♥. So you say 2♥. Partner now bids 2NT.

What is your bid?

Partner's bidding shows 9 points and exactly 5♥. He asks that you take him back to ♥s if you have 3 of them. You don't. He is asking you to bid game if you have 17 points or a good 16. You don't.

So you pass.

***Board 2***
East Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A 8 7 5<br>♥ J 10 7 2<br>♦ A 7 6<br>♣ 8 6 | |
| ♠ K J 10 6 3<br>♥ 9 6<br>♦ 9 8 2<br>♣ K J 4 |  | ♠ Q 4<br>♥ A Q 8<br>♦ K Q 10 5<br>♣ A 10 9 3 |
| | ♠ 9 2<br>♥ K 5 4 3<br>♦ J 4 3<br>♣ Q 7 5 2 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | 1NT | Pass |
| 2♥ | Pass | 2♠ | Pass |
| 2NT | Pass | 3NT | |
| All Pass | | | |

3NT by East
Lead: ♣2

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♥.

Naturally you say 2♠. Partner comes back with 2NT.

Partner's bidding shows 9 points and exactly 5♠. He asks that you take him back to ♠s if you have 3 of them. You don't. He is asking you to bid game if you have 17 points. You do.

So you bid 3NT.

***Board 3***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 9 3<br>♥ Q J 10 6 2<br>♦ 7 5 3<br>♣ K Q 4 | |
| ♠ K J 10 7 5<br>♥ K 9 4<br>♦ 8 4 2<br>♣ J 7 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ Q 8 4<br>♥ A 3<br>♦ J 10 9 6<br>♣ 6 5 3 2 |
| | ♠ A 6 2<br>♥ 8 7 5<br>♦ A K Q<br>♣ A 10 9 8 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1NT |
| Pass | 2♦ | Pass | 2♥ |
| Pass | 2NT | Pass | 4♥ |
| All Pass | | | |

4♥ by South
Lead: ♦2

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♦.

Partner's command is your wish - you say 2♥.

He now bids 2NT.

Partner's bidding shows 9 points and exactly 5♥. He asks that you take him back to ♥s if you have 3 of them. You do. He is asking you to bid game if you have 17 points. You do.

So you bid 4♥.

With your 3-3-3-4 distribution you might have been tempted to bid 3NT instead of 4♥. It's a good thing you didn't, they would have killed you in ♠s.

***Board 4***
West Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ Q 8 4 2<br>♥ K 9 6 3<br>♦ K 4<br>♣ 10 9 4 | |
| ♠ J 6<br>♥ A 7 5<br>♦ A Q 7 2<br>♣ K J 8 3 |  | ♠ A K 9 7 5 3<br>♥ 8 4 2<br>♦ 5 3<br>♣ 7 6 |
| | ♠ 10<br>♥ Q J 10<br>♦ J 10 9 8 6<br>♣ A Q 5 2 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1NT | Pass | 2♥ | Pass |
| 2♠ | Pass | 3♠ | |
| All Pass | | | |

3♠ by West
Lead: ♣10

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♥.

The initial response to a transfer is really easy. You bid 2♠.

But what do you bid after partner then says 3♠?

Partner has 6 ♠s and you have 2. So a ♠ contract is fine.

Partner has 9 points and you have 15. So a game contract is too high.

You pass. And you're going to have to play great to make even 9 tricks!

***Board 5***
North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 6
♥ 9 6 5
♦ K Q J 2
♣ A K 9 8

♠ J 10 5 4 2
♥ Q 3
♦ 8 7 4
♣ Q J 4




♠ K Q 9
♥ J 4
♦ A 10 6 5
♣ 10 7 3 2

♠ 8 7 3
♥ A K 10 8 7 2
♦ 9 3
♣ 6 5

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1NT | Pass | 2♦ |
| Pass | 2♥ | Pass | 3♥ |
| Pass | 4♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

4♥ by North
Lead: ♠K

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♦.

You follow orders and say 2♥.

Partner follows up with 3♥.

Partner has 9 points and 6 ♥s. You have 17 points and 3 ♥s. That adds up to 26 points and 9 ♥s. You have enough points for game and enough trumps to play ♥s so you bid 4♥.